MARINDUQUE INNOVATION FEST 2026

Innovation Fest Hackathon

Theme:
"Code for Marinduque: Innovate, Create, Transform"

I. Program Description

The **Marinduque Innovation Fest 2026 Hackathon** is a collaborative innovation activity that brings together students, developers, designers, and innovators to create technology-driven solutions to local challenges in Marinduque. Participants will work in teams to develop and pitch innovative solutions within a given timeframe, supported by mentors and technical experts. The activity aims to foster creativity, collaboration, problem-solving, and the development of practical solutions using emerging technologies.

II. Objectives

General Objective:

To foster innovation, creativity, and collaboration among students, developers, entrepreneurs, and technology enthusiasts by developing technology-driven solutions that address actual challenges and opportunities in Marinduque.

Specific Objectives:

1. Identify local challenges that can be addressed through technology and innovation.
2. Develop innovative solutions through collaborative problem-solving.
3. Enhance technical skills in programming, design, AI, and emerging technologies.
4. Promote collaboration among students, developers, startups, academe, and government.
5. Strengthen the local innovation ecosystem through mentoring and networking.
6. Showcase promising prototypes with potential for further development and adoption.
7. Encourage sustainable innovation that benefits Marinduque communities.

III. Eligibility

- Each participating team must be composed of exactly three (3) members and one (1) coach/mentor.
- The coach will only provide mentorship and guidance throughout the competition.
- All members must be currently enrolled high school or college students in any educational institution located in Marinduque.
- Teams can be composed of individuals of mixed genders and from different academic programs.
- There is no age limit for participation.
- Submissions must represent original research or conceptualized prototypes developed by the proponents.
- The group should submit only one (1) entry to participate in the competition.
- Each team shall designate one member as its Team Leader/Authorized Representative, who will serve as the primary contact person for the organizers.
- Participants must accomplish the official registration form and submit all required documents within the prescribed deadlines.
- Employees of DOST and members of the organizing committee are not eligible to join.

IV. Contest Theme

Theme: *Code for Marinduque: Innovate, Create, Transform*

Participants are required to develop an original and innovative prototype aligned with the provided theme, focusing on addressing relevant local challenges and demonstrating the potential of technology to provide practical, sustainable, and impactful solutions for the community. The team may explore these fields, but is not limited to:

- Agriculture & Food Innovation
- Disaster Risk Reduction/ Climate Change Adaptation
- Blue Economy & Marine Innovation
- Digital Technology & AI
- Health & Wellness Innovation
- Tourism & Cultural Innovation
- Creative Technology & E-Sports Game
- Governance & Smart Communities

V. Contest Mechanics

A. Registration

1. Interested teams shall register through the **official registration form on or before October 6, 2026.**
2. Each group shall submit the names and contact details of its three (3) members and coach.
3. Student participants **below 18 years old shall submit the required Parent/Guardian Consent Form.**
4. Only one person (the designated Team Leader) is allowed to register the entire team using the provided form.
5. **Registration link:** https://forms.gle/LZJ2Y7p3EqPaZ5V86

B. Entry Submission

1. **Proposal and Other Requirements**
   - Each team is required to submit the following:
     - **Curriculum Vitae (CV) of each team members**
     - **Official Group Photo of Team**
       i. Submit one (1) portrait and one (1) landscape group photo.
       ii. Use a plain white background with good lighting.
       iii. Ensure all team members are shown full-body, with faces clearly visible and unobstructed.
       iv. Photos must be clear, high-resolution, and properly framed.
       v. Avoid excessive filters, effects, or heavy editing.
       vi. Wear appropriate and presentable attire; team shirts/uniforms are encouraged, if applicable.
       vii. Submit photos in JPG or PNG format.

- **Proposal**

  i. All submissions must adhere to standard academic writing conventions and include the following sections.
     1. Document Format:
        a. Paper Size: A4 paper
        b. Font: Time New Roman, 12 pt.
        c. Spacing and Margins: Double Spacing, standard 1-inch margins
        d. File Format: Must be in PDF format.
     2. Proposal Structure:
        - Title Page: Project title, team name, and contact details of all members.
        - Abstract: A brief overview of the problem, the proposed solution, and the target impact.

  ii. Note: No prototype is required during the initial submission. Teams are only required to submit their concept and supporting documents at this stage.

- **Submission link:** https://forms.gle/oE93tCN8h1YjBJuX7
- **Deadline: October 16, 2026**

- Late submissions will not be accommodated to ensure ample time for the screening process.

C. Initial Screening

1. All submitted documents shall undergo an initial screening by the designated Initial Screening Panel/Organizing Committee.
2. The purpose of the initial screening is to identify the **Top Five (5) Finalists.**
3. The initial screening will use a standardized scoring rubric.
4. Whenever practicable, entries shall be identified by entry codes rather than team names, schools, or participant names during scoring to minimize bias.
5. Initial screening scores shall not be disclosed to the final judges.
6. The five (5) entries with the highest consolidated scores shall advance as finalists.
7. The organizers shall notify the selected and non-selected groups on **October 21, 2026.**

The initial screening shall focus on the overall merit and suitability of the entries for advancement to the final round.

Criteria	**Weight**
Team Capability & Technical Skills	25%
Problem Identification & Relevance	25%
Proposed Solution & Innovation	20%
Technical & Business Viability	15%
Clarity & Completeness of Submission	15%
TOTAL	**100%**

The initial screening panel shall use a common scoring guide to promote consistency among evaluators.

D. Webinar Bootcamp Attendance

- Registered participants **must attend the Webinar Bootcamp on Design Thinking and Idea Pitching**. The bootcamp will be organized by the Organizing Committee, and the details will be provided once finalized.
- The bootcamp will be conducted on either **October 8, 2026**. Final details will be communicated via email.
- Teams may refine and enhance their concepts based on the knowledge and insights gained during the bootcamp. The **final proposal must be submitted on October 16, 2026**. After the submission deadline, **no changes, revisions, or introduction of new concepts will be allowed**.

VI. Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Use of AI-generated code will only be allowed as an assistive tool such as for utility functions, boilerplates, etc. and not as a substitute for authorship of the core gameplay logic and narrative system. It shall be fully disclosed to the organizers and judges and does not reproduce or infringe upon existing copyright or open-source material.

If AI is used in the integration of games such as Large Language Models (LLM) or Generative AI, its usage must be disclosed and must not violate any of the restrictions mentioned above.

Participants who use AI in any part of their entry must ensure that its application adheres to the following ethical standards:

- Clearly disclose all AI tools or models used, including their specific function or purpose, in the official submission form;
- Ensure that the entry reflects originality and substantial creative input beyond AI-generated content;
- Guarantee that any AI-generated elements do not infringe on intellectual property rights; and
- Comply with a content review process, during which the Organizing Committee may request additional documentation or clarification regarding the extent of AI usage.

The Organizing Committee reserves the right to disqualify any entry that fails to meet these ethical guidelines.

VI. Contest Proper (In-House Rules and Guidelines)

1. Instructions During Contest

- A formal draw will be conducted to determine the specific sector or field that each team will focus on.
- Teams are tasked with brainstorming and conceptualizing their own tech-business Information System (IS).
- The final output must be a fully working prototype of an Information System, specifically an App or Website.

2. The Hackathon Environment & Logistics

- The development phase of the competition will run for two (2) days inside Marinduque State University.

- Participants are permitted to conceptualize and develop their systems strictly between 1:00 PM to 5:00 PM on day 1 and 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM on day 2.

- **Logistics Note:** Due to budget constraints, no overnight accommodation will be provided; participants are expected to go home after the 5:00 P.M. cutoff. Lunch and snacks will be provided during the event.
- **Strict Confinement:** During the designated daily working hours, participants are strictly prohibited from leaving the venue premises except for health breaks or other authorized purposes.
- **Mentorship:** Each team will be assigned one (1) official mentor during the event to guide their conceptualization and development.
- No spectators are allowed in the venue premises

3. Development Restrictions & Monitoring

- **Software & Hardware:** Teams will use any software in creating their prototype using their personal laptops. GitHub/GDrive will be used to track the team's progress.
- At the end of each day, the assigned facilitator must be given access to the team's GitHub/GDrive repository to track their progress.
- **No Cellphones:** The use of mobile phones is strictly prohibited during the development phase.
- **Use of AI is Allowed:** The use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Copilot, etc.) to generate code or ideas is allowed.
- **From Scratch:** All coding, database creation, and UI/UX designing must be built entirely from scratch during the two (2)-day duration. Pre-existing projects will not be accepted.
- Changing or writing codes outside the allotted daily time limit is strictly prohibited.
- All violations of these rules will be subject to disqualification from the competition.

4. Pitching Proper

- Finalists will present their idea live before the Board of Judges and an audience during the Marinduque Innovation Fest 2026.
- The Finalists shall prepare a **Pitch Presentation Deck** highlighting the identified problem, proposed solution, science, technology, and innovation (STI) component, implementation approach, and expected community impact of their proposed innovation.
    - The use of prototypes, demonstration models, videos, and other supporting materials are required.
- Each team shall be allotted:
    - Seven (7) minutes for the Innovation Pitch; and
    - 13 minutes for the Question-and-Answer Session.
- Following the pitch, the BOJ shall ask questions; any team member may answer during this portion.

5. FILING OF PROTEST ABOUT THE RESULTS

- The team mentor or representative shall only file a protest within 30 minutes after the competition proper is over in the form of a letter sent to pstc.marinduque@mimaropa.dost.gov.ph.
- Protests shall only be entertained after the competition.
- The decision of the BOJ is final and irrevocable.

VII. Output Specification

Participants are expected to submit the following outputs:

1. **Working Prototype** – A functional prototype that addresses the identified problem and is aligned with the hackathon theme.
2. **Project Documentation** – A brief document describing the problem, proposed solution, key features, technology used, and potential impact.
3. **Source Code/Technical Files** – Complete source code and other necessary files used to develop the prototype.
4. **Pitch Deck** – A presentation highlighting the problem, solution, target users, innovation, business/sustainability potential, and impact.
5. **Prototype Demonstration** – A live demonstration showcasing the prototype's key features and functionality.
6. **Final Pitch Presentation** – A short presentation to the panel of judges explaining the solution, its uniqueness, feasibility, and potential contribution to Marinduque.

VIII. Submission Requirements

A. Registration Stage — Deadline: October 6, 2026
- Accomplished Registration Form**;**
- Names and details of the three team members and mentor/coach;
- Team Leader/Authorized Representative; and
- **Parent/Guardian Consent Form** for participants below 18 years old;

B. Initial Screening Documents Submission - Deadline: October 16, 2026
- Curriculum Vitae
- Official Group Photo
- Proposal / project concept

IX. Criteria for Final Judging

Criteria	**Weight**	
Relevance to the theme: - Agriculture & Food Innovation	25%	**Agriculture and Food Innovation** – This sector focuses on innovative solutions that

- Disaster Risk Reduction/ Climate Change Adaptation - Blue Economy & Marine Innovation - Digital Technology & AI - Health & Wellness Innovation - Tourism & Cultural Innovation - Creative Technology & E- E-Sports Game - Governance & Smart Communities		improve agricultural productivity, food production, processing, and sustainability. Ideas may include smart farming technologies, precision agriculture, agricultural automation, food processing and preservation, post-harvest technologies, aquaculture, and the development of value-added agricultural products. **Blue Economy and Marine Innovation** – This sector focuses on the sustainable use, protection, and development of marine and coastal resources. Proposed innovations may address marine aquaculture, fisheries, coastal resource management, marine biodiversity monitoring, ocean technologies, and sustainable livelihood opportunities for coastal communities. **Environment and Climate Innovation** – This sector encourages solutions addressing environmental challenges, climate change, and disaster risks. Ideas may include waste management, recycling and circular economy initiatives, renewable energy applications, biodiversity conservation, climate change adaptation, disaster risk reduction, and technologies that promote environmental sustainability. **Digital Technology and Artificial Intelligence** – This sector focuses on the development and application of digital technologies to address real-world problems. Participants may propose innovations involving artificial intelligence, mobile and web applications, Internet of Things (IoT), automation, data analytics, cybersecurity, digital platforms, and other emerging technologies. **Health and Wellness Innovation** This sector focuses on innovative solutions that improve healthcare services, health monitoring, wellness, and quality of life. Ideas may include digital health applications, remote health monitoring, assistive technologies, community health solutions, nutrition innovations, and technologies that improve access to

		healthcare services. **Tourism and Creative Innovation** This sector promotes innovative ideas that enhance tourism, culture, heritage, and creative industries. Proposed solutions may include smart tourism platforms, digital tourism experiences, cultural heritage preservation technologies, augmented or virtual reality applications, creative media, animation, and innovative ways of promoting local destinations and products. **Creative Technology and E-Games Innovation** – This sector focuses on the use of technology to develop creative digital products and experiences. Participants may propose innovations involving game development, animation, augmented reality (AR), virtual reality (VR), digital media, interactive applications, and creative uses of artificial intelligence and other emerging technologies. **Governance and Smart Community Innovation** – This sector focuses on technology-driven solutions that improve public services, governance, and community development. Ideas may include e-governance platforms, smart community systems, digital public services, citizen reporting applications, community information systems, disaster response technologies, and solutions that promote more efficient and responsive local government services.
Technical Execution & Prototype Functionality	25%	Assesses how effectively the team develops a working, functional, and technically sound prototype that demonstrates the proposed solution.
Tech-Business Viability & Innovation	20%	Assesses the innovation, originality, technical potential, and business viability of the proposed solution, including its potential for real-world application and sustainability.

User Interface (UI) & User Experience (UX)	15%	Assesses the design, usability, accessibility, and overall user experience of the prototype.
Pitch Presentation & Live Demo	15%	team's **clarity, effectiveness, and confidence in presenting the solution**, including the quality and functionality of the live demonstration.
TOTAL	**100**%	

X. Scoring Rubrics

a. Initial Screening

Criteria	**Excellent**	**Good**	**Fair**	**Poor**
Team Capability & Technical Skills (25%)	**21-25** Team demonstrates highly relevant technical skills, experience, and complementary expertise.	**16-20** Team demonstrates relevant skills and sufficient technical capability.	**11-15** Team has some relevant skills but with noticeable gaps.	**0-10** Team lacks relevant skills or technical capability.
Problem Identification & Relevance (25%)	**21-25** Clearly identifies a significant, well-defined, and highly relevant problem.	**16-20** Identifies a relevant and clearly defined problem.	**11-15** Problem is somewhat relevant but lacks clarity or sufficient detail.	**0-10** Problem is unclear, poorly defined, or has limited relevance.
Proposed Solution & Innovation (20%)	**17-20** Presents a highly innovative, original, and promising solution to the identified problem.	**13-16** Presents a creative and relevant solution with innovative elements.	**9-12** Solution is relevant but demonstrates limited innovation or originality.	**0-8** Solution lacks innovation, originality, or clear connection to the problem.

Technical & Business Viability (15%)	**13-15** Solution demonstrates strong technical feasibility and clear potential for practical application or sustainability.	**11-13** Solution is generally feasible and has potential for practical application.	**8-10** Feasibility or practical application is uncertain and requires further development.	**0-7** Solution is difficult to implement or has little practical potential.
Clarity & Completeness of Submission (15%)	**13-15** Submission is complete, well-organized, clear, and professionally presented.	**11-13** Submission is complete and generally clear and organized.	**8-10** Submission is partially complete or lacks clarity in some areas.	**0-7** Submission is incomplete, unclear, or poorly organized.
TOTAL - **100**				

b. Final Judging

Criteria	**Excellent**	**Good**	**Fair**	**Poor**
Relevance to the Theme **25%**	**21-25** Solution directly and comprehensively addresses the Hackathon theme/problem with a clear and meaningful approach.	**16–20** Solution clearly addresses the theme/problem with minor gaps.	**11–15:** Solution is somewhat relevant but has limited connection to the theme/problem.	**10 & below** Solution has little or no clear connection to the theme/problem.
Technical Execution & Prototype Functionality **25 %**	**21-25** Prototype is highly functional, technically sound, and effectively	**16–20** Prototype is functional and demonstrates most key features, with	**11–15** Prototype has limited functionality and demonstrates only some of the	**10 & below** Prototype is largely non-functional or fails to

	demonstrates the proposed solution with minimal or no issues.	minor technical issues.	proposed features.	demonstrate the proposed solution.
Tech-Business Viability & Innovation **20%**	**18–20** Solution is highly innovative, technically viable, scalable, and has strong potential for real-world application or commercialization.	**16–17** Solution demonstrates innovation and good potential for practical or business application.	**13–15** Solution shows some innovation but has significant limitations in technical or business viability.	**12 & below** Solution demonstrates little innovation and has limited practical or business potential.
User Interface (UI) & User Experience (UX) **15%**	**14–15** Interface is intuitive, accessible, visually coherent, easy to navigate, and provides an excellent user experience.	**12–13** Interface is user-friendly and functional with minor usability or design issues.	**10–11** Interface is usable but has noticeable issues in navigation, design, or user experience.	**9 & below** Interface is difficult to use, confusing, or lacks essential usability considerations.
Pitch Presentation & Live Demo **15%**	**14–15** Presentation is clear, compelling, well-structured, and delivered confidently; live demo effectively demonstrates the solution and handles questions well.	**12–13** Presentation is clear and organized; demo demonstrates the main features with minor issues.	**10–11** Presentation communicates the basic concept but lacks clarity, organization, or effective demonstration.	**9 & below** Presentation is unclear or poorly organized, and the demo fails to effectively demonstrate the solution.
Total – 100%				

XI. Tie - Breaking Rule

Initial Screening

In the event of a **tie in the final scores**, the winner shall be determined **based on the higher score in the following criteria, in order of priority:**

1. **Team Capability & Technical Skills**
2. **Problem Identification & Relevance**
3. **Proposed Solution & Innovation**
4. **Technical & Business Viability**
5. **Clarity & Completeness of Submission**

If a tie still exists after applying the above criteria, the Screening Panel shall deliberate and determine the winner based on the overall merit of the proposed idea, in accordance with the Guidelines and Mechanics. The decision of the Screening Panel shall be final and irrevocable.

Final Judging
In the event of a **tie in the final scores**, the winner shall be determined **based on the higher score in the following criteria, in order of priority:**

1. **Relevance to the Theme**
2. **Technical Execution & Prototype Functionality**
3. **Tech-Business Viability & Innovation**
4. **User Interface (UI) & User Experience (UX)**
5. **Pitch Presentation & Live Demo**

If a tie still exists after applying the above criteria, the Board of Judges shall deliberate based on the overall merit of the proposed solution, technical feasibility, functionality, innovation, potential impact, and the team's overall presentation and demonstration. The decision of the Panel of Judges shall be final and irrevocable.

XII. Prizes and Recognition

The following awards shall be given:

Award	**Prize**
Champion	₱10,000
First Runner-Up	₱5,000
Second Runner-Up	₱3,000

Awardees shall also receive **medals**. The awarding ceremony shall be held in the last week of October as part of the Marinduque Innovation Fest 2026.

All shortlisted qualifiers who successfully present their research during the event will receive a Certificate of Participation to acknowledge their contribution to the event.

XIII. Conflict of Interest and Impartiality

- All judges and screeners shall be required to declare any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest involving a participating team.
- A judge/screener with a conflict of interest shall recuse themselves from evaluating the concerned entry, subject to the procedures determined by the organizers.
- Judges and screeners shall evaluate entries independently and shall not disclose or discuss their scores with other evaluators during the evaluation period.

- Initial screening scores shall remain confidential and shall not be used by the final judges in determining the winners.

XIV. Organizer's Decision

The organizers reserve the right to:

1. Verify the authenticity, originality, and compliance of submitted entries;
2. Request additional documentation or evidence from participating teams;
3. Disqualify entries found to be in violation of these Guidelines and Mechanics;
4. Make necessary interpretations or clarifications regarding provisions not specifically covered herein; and
5. Take appropriate action in cases of unforeseen circumstances affecting the conduct of the competition.

All decisions of the organizers concerning eligibility, compliance, and contest administration shall be final. The decision of the Final Judging Panel regarding the ranking of finalists shall be final and irrevocable, subject to verification of compliance with the competition rules.

XV. Timeline

DATE	ACTIVITY
October 6, 2026	Registration Deadline
October 8, 2026	Webinar Bootcamp
October 16, 2026	Deadline for submission of final proposal and required documents
October 17–20, 2026	Initial screening and evaluation
October 21, 2026	Announcement/notification of five (5) finalists

XVI. Contact Information

For questions regarding the submission guidelines or the iHub launch event, please contact:

DOST MARINDUQUE
Email: pstc.marinduque@mimaropa.dost.gov.ph
Facebook: DOST-Provincial S&T Center Marinduque
Tel. No.: (042)-332-0302
Mobile Number: 09670847266

MARINDUQUE IHUB
Email: marinduqueihub@gmail.com
Facebook: Marinduque iHub
Tel. No.: (042)-332-0302
Mobile Number: 09670847266

- Name: Santy Anthony J. Jalla, Event Coordinator
- Phone: 09543869865/332-0302
- Messenger: Santy Anthony Jalla / DOST Provincial S&T Center Marinduque

Approved by:

[SGD]
DR. BERNARDO N. SEPEDA
Regional Director

PARENT/GUARDIAN CONSENT AND WAIVER

Innovation Fest Hackathon

I, _____, parent/legal guardian of _____, ____ **years old**, affiliated with _____ **(School/Organization)**, hereby give my **voluntary consent** for my child/ward to participate in the **Innovation Fest Hackathon.**

I understand and agree that participation includes activities necessary for the preparation and completion of the hackathon entry, including orientations, meetings, workshops, mentoring sessions, problem identification and solution development, prototyping, testing and refinement, preparation of required materials and presentations, rehearsals, the solution demonstration/presentation, submission of requirements, and other hackathon-related activities.

I further give my consent for my child/ward to **attend the awarding ceremony and related activities if the entry is selected as a finalist**.

I understand that participation in the competition is **voluntary** and that the participant is expected to comply with the competition rules, guidelines, schedules, and safety instructions of the organizers.

I acknowledge that participation may involve prototype demonstrations and presentations, use of computers and other equipment, and testing, travel, and other competition-related activities.

To the extent permitted by applicable law, I agree that the **Innovation Fest Hackathon** organizers, their representatives, staff, partners, mentors, and volunteers shall not be held liable for any injury, loss, damage, or expense arising from my child's/ward's voluntary participation in the hackathon and its related activities, except where such liability is caused by the organizers' proven negligence, willful misconduct, or circumstances for which liability cannot legally be waived. .

Unless otherwise provided by the organizers, I understand that **transportation, personal expenses, equipment, and other incidental costs** related to participation shall be the responsibility of the participant and/or parent/guardian.

By signing below, I confirm that I have **read, understood, and voluntarily agreed** to this Consent and Waiver and authorize my child/ward to participate in the **Innovation Fest Hackathon.**

PARENT/GUARDIAN INFORMATION

Relationship to Participant: _____

Contact No.: _____

Email Address: _____

Signature over Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

Postal Address DOST-MIMAROPA, 4/F PTRI Bldg. Gen. Santos Ave., Bicutan, Taguig City
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E-mail Address official@mimaropa.dost.gov.ph